



ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION
UNION PANAFRICAINNE DES ETUDIANTS
UNIÃO DOS ESTUDANTES DE TODA A ÁFRICA
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INTERNATIONAL DAY OF THE GIRL CHILD

CONCEPT NOTE



11 October, 2022

1.0 BACKGROUND AND JUSTIFICATION

On December 19, 2011, United Nations General Assembly adopted Resolution 66/170 to declare October 11 as the International Day of the Girl Child, to recognize girls' rights and the unique challenges girls face around the world. The International Day of the Girl Child focuses attention on the need to address the challenges girls face and to promote girls' empowerment and the fulfilment of their human rights.

As we commemorate the 10th anniversary of the International Day of the Girl (IDG) in 2022, there now increased attention on issues that matter to girls amongst governments, policy-makers and the general public, and more opportunities for girls to have their voices heard on the global stage. Yet, investments in girls' rights remain limited and girls continue to confront a myriad of challenges to fulfilling their potential; made worse by concurrent crises of climate change, COVID-19 and humanitarian conflict.

According to the Gender Inequality Report, 2022 although giant strides have been made in girls' and women's education in the last decade, out of the 163 million illiterate youth across the globe, nearly 63 percent are female. In sub-Saharan Africa, for instance, more than one in four young women do not yet know how to read or write. Indeed, for all learners to be equal, education actors must make gender equality central to their actions.

Literacy is today seen to include more than just a set of reading, writing, and math skills. It is also a way of identifying, comprehending, interpreting, creating, and communicating in a world that is increasingly digital and dynamic. The "multiplier effect" of literacy enables people to engage fully in society, improve their quality of life and empower them. It has the ability to increase labor market participation, improve family health and nutrition, reduce poverty, and increase life possibilities for girls.

According to UNESCO, at least 773 million youth and adults still cannot read and write and 250 million children are failing to acquire basic literacy skills. In 2021, 36.2% percent of people aged 15 years and above in Africa were unable to read and write a simple statement and understand it. This results in an exclusion of low-literate and low-skilled youth and adults from full participation in their communities and societies. The sustainability and progress of all regions depend on the success of women across the globe and the role of education of women and girls cannot be overemphasized.

To advance literacy as an integral part of lifelong learning, the All-Africa Students Union seeks to organize a **Literacy Workshop and Book Seminar** for the African girlchild. This project will be piloted in Ghana in partnership with the National Union of Graduate Students and the Graduate Students Association of Ghana this year on **11th October, 2022** which marks International Day of the Girl Child. Subsequently, same will held in Uganda, Central African Republic and Benin.

2.0 PROGRAMME OBJECTIVES

- Empower 100 girls with skills in reading, digital literacy tools, and communication
- Create awareness on the expansion of the definition of literacy and its contribution towards national development.
- Advocate for the building of E-Libraries and the upgrade of existing libraries into E-Libraries particularly in deprived communities.

3.0 PROGRAMME ACTIVITY

- First Session: Essay and Article presentation by Students on proposed theme.
- Second Session: Workshop

4.0 PROGRAMME OUTCOMES

- Participants Informed on the importance of increased literacy rates of the girlchild towards national development.
- Commitment from takeholders to build E-libraries and upgrade existing community libraries.
- Concerted efforts amassed to sustain literacy advocacy amongst students and stakeholders.

5.0 DATE & TIME

It will be a one-day programme which will be held on **11th October, 2022** at **11:00am GMT**.

6.0 PROGRAMME BENEFICIARIES

- Junior High Schools
- Senior High Schools

7.0 PROPOSED PARTNERS





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